

that you had nothing? Would that be any less real? And what would you do about it if the bank insisted that it was not there? Would you go to the bank and look around in the corners to see if you could find it? Would you ask the tellers if they had seen it recently? How would you describe it to them?

And if it were suddenly gone, would you miss it? Chances are, you wouldn't notice that it had gone at all. For what did you ever do with it? You couldn't eat it. You couldn't wear it. You couldn't play with it. Scrooge McDuck kept his fortune in gold coins. In the comic books, he loved to dive into it and play with it. But you can't do that with an electronic fortune.

That's why it is so easy to say goodbye to it. You never got to know it in the first place.

A business is different. It is much more real, tangible, in your face, and demanding. It has doors that need to be opened in the morning and lights that need to be turned off at night. It has people, too: employees who need direction and salaries; customers who have questions, needs, complaints, and desires; and directors, managers, lawyers, bankers—all with their own points of view.

- Money is quiet. A business talks back to you.
- Money is anonymous. A business has a distinct personality.
- Money does what it's told. A business has a mind of its own.
- Money is fickle and runs around. A business is steadfast and loyal.
- Money is easy come, easy go. A business drags its feet in coming and digs in its heels when it is time to go home.
- Money is easy. A business is tough.
- Remember our general rule: The harder it is, *ceteris paribus*, the better it is. The longer it takes to make money, the longer it is likely to stick around.
- The harder it is to make, the less likely you are to lose it.